

Absolutely — **however** is another excellent **grammar/polyfunctionality** target. In your passage it is a **contrastive linking adverb**, but modern English also uses **however** to mean **“no matter how / in whatever way / to whatever degree”**, and in some conversational British-style questions it can intensify **how**.

Word family: **however**

Base word: however

Part of speech / function: conjunctive adverb (連接副詞) / adverb (副詞)

Useful constructions: however + clause, however + adjective/adverb, however much/many, however hard, however you..., however did...?

However has no useful derivational family of its own. Its learning value comes from its **different grammatical functions and meanings**, so it should be treated as a grammar/polyfunctionality word rather than artificially given a large “word family.”

Your sentence:

> **“However**, once he started teaching, he became much more lively than people expected.”

Meaning in your passage: **however** = nevertheless / in contrast — 不過；然而；可是

Here **however** signals a contrast between two ideas:

1. He **looked serious at first sight**.
2. Once he started teaching, he became **much more lively**.

So **however** tells the reader:

> **what follows contrasts with what was just said.**

繁體中文：

用來引出與前文形成對比、轉折或部分相反的情況；不過 / 然而 / 可是

Natural translation:

> “However, once he started teaching, he became much more lively than people expected.”

「**不過 / 然而**，一旦他開始上課，他就比大家想像中生動得多。」

So here:

> **however** = 不過 / 然而，用來引出與前文印象相反的情況

1. **however**, + clause (轉折) — 不過 ; 然而 ; 可是

This is your exact source use.

Practice 1 — Original

> “**However**, once he started teaching, he became much more lively than people expected.”

「**不過**，一旦他開始上課，他就比大家想像中生動得多。」

Practice 2

> “The teacher looked strict. **However**, he was very patient with weaker students.”

「那位老師看起來很嚴格。**然而**，他對能力較弱的學生非常有耐性。」

Practice 3

> “The exam was difficult. **However**, most students passed.”

「考試很難。**不過**，大部分學生都合格了。」

however — contrast = 引出與前文預期、描述或結論形成轉折 / 對比的新資訊

2. **clause; however, clause** (句中轉折) — 然而 ; 不過

However does not have to appear at the very beginning.

Practice 4

> “He was strict; **however**, he was always fair.”

「他很嚴格；**不過**，他一直很公道。」

Practice 5

> “The idea seemed simple. It was, **however**, difficult to apply.”

「這個想法看似簡單。**然而**，實際應用起來卻很困難。」

however = 可以放在句首、句中或分號後，引出轉折資訊

Common positions:

> **However**, the lesson was useful.

> The lesson, **however**, was useful.

> The lesson was difficult; **however**, it was useful.

The punctuation changes with position.

3. **however** = nevertheless / despite that (讓步結果) — 儘管如此 ; 即使如此

Sometimes **however** carries a slightly stronger “despite what was just said” meaning.

Practice 6

> “The class was tiring. **However**, I learned a great deal.”

「那堂課很累人。**儘管如此**，我還是學到了很多。」

Practice 7

> “He made mistakes. **However**, the overall result was excellent.”

「他犯了一些錯誤。**即使如此**，整體結果仍然非常出色。」

however = 承認前文的情況成立，但指出後面的結果仍然不同 / 不受完全影響

This belongs to the same broad contrastive connector sense as #1, so we should not over-split it.

4. **however** + adjective/adverb + subject + verb (不論多麼.....) — 無論多..... ; 不管多.....
**

Now the meaning changes substantially.

Practice 8

> “**However difficult** the question is, try to answer it.”

「**無論問題多麼困難**，都要嘗試回答。」

Practice 9

> “However carefully he explained it, some students were still confused.”

「**無論他解釋得多麼仔細**，仍然有些學生感到困惑。」

however + adjective/adverb = no matter how + adjective/adverb ; 不論程度有多高，主句結果仍然成立

This is genuinely different from contrastive **However, ...**

5. **however much + uncountable noun / verb (無論多少 / 多麼) — 無論多少 ; 不管多麼**

Practice 10

> “**However much time** you spend memorising, understanding is still important.”

「**無論你花多少時間**背誦，理解仍然很重要。」

Practice 11

> “However much I admire him, I know he was not perfect.”

「**無論我多麼欣賞他 / 儘管我非常欣賞他**，我也知道他並不完美。」

however much = 不論數量有多少，或某種感情 / 程度有多強

Two common patterns:

* however much + noun

* however much + subject + verb

6. **however many + plural noun (無論有多少.....) — 不管多少.....**

Practice 12

> “**However many questions** the students asked, he answered them patiently.”

「**無論學生問多少問題**，他都耐心回答。」

Practice 13

> “However many examples you give, some learners will still want more.”

「**無論你提供多少例子**，仍然會有些學習者想要更多。」

however many + plural noun = 不論可數人 / 事物的數量有多大

Compare:

* however much time

* however many questions

7. **however + subject + verb (無論怎樣 / 以任何方式) — 無論怎樣；不管用甚麼方法**

A major meaning.

Practice 14

> “**However you explain it**, make sure the main idea is clear.”

「**無論你怎樣解釋**，都要確保主要概念清楚。」

Practice 15

> “However he approached the problem, he reached the same conclusion.”

「**無論他用甚麼方法處理這個問題**，最後都得出相同結論。」

however + clause = 不論以甚麼方式、方法或途徑做某事

Here **however** is close to:

> **no matter how**

8. **however = in whatever way (任何方式) — 怎樣都可以；不論用甚麼方式**

In some sentences, the emphasis is not concession but freedom of method.

Practice 16

> “You may organise the notes **however you like**.”

「你可以**按自己喜歡的任何方式**整理筆記。」

Practice 17

> “Arrange the chairs however you think is best.”

「你認為怎樣最好，就**按那種方式**擺放椅子。」

however = 以任何你選擇 / 認為合適的方式

This is closely related to #7 but especially common with:

* however you like

* however you want

* however you prefer

* however you think best

9. **however + adjective/adverb = to whatever degree (無論程度多高)**

This construction deserves reinforcement because it is one of the biggest learner traps.

Practice 18

> “**However tired** you are, finish the final paragraph.”

「**無論你有多累**，都要完成最後一段。」

Practice 19

> “However slowly he spoke, the class listened carefully.”

「**無論他說得多慢**，全班都仔細聆聽。」

however + degree expression = 無論某種程度達到多高 / 多低，後面的情況仍成立

10. **however did/could/would...? (驚訝疑問；較口語 / 英式) — 到底怎麼.....？究竟怎麼.....？**

A useful conversational/emphatic use.

Practice 20

> “**However did you remember** all those dates?”

「你**到底是怎麼記住**那些年份的？」

Practice 21

> “However did he manage to make the lesson so interesting?”

「他**究竟怎麼做到**把課堂教得那麼有趣？」

however + auxiliary + subject...? = 用來加強 how 疑問，表示驚訝、難以理解或強烈好奇

Register:

- * especially conversational
- * more common in British English
- * often equivalent to **how on earth...?**

This is not the same as sentence-linking **however**.

11. **however that may be / however it may be (較正式) — 不管怎樣；無論情況如何**

A formal fixed-style construction.

Practice 22

> “**However that may be**, the evidence is still incomplete.”

「**無論如何 / 不管情況怎樣**，證據仍然不完整。」

Practice 23

> “However it may be explained, the result remains surprising.”

「**無論怎樣解釋**，這個結果仍然令人驚訝。」

however + be-clause = 不論實際情況 / 解釋如何，主句仍然成立

Register: formal.

Important distinction: **however vs but**

This is crucial.

but

is a coordinating conjunction:

> “He looked strict, **but** he was kind.”

「他看起來嚴格，**但**他很友善。」

however

is a conjunctive adverb:

> “He looked strict. **However** , he was kind.”

「他看起來嚴格。 **然而** , 他很友善。」

Normally avoid:

> “He looked strict, however he was kind.” ✗

with only a comma joining two independent clauses.

Better:

> “He looked strict; however, he was kind.”

or:

> “He looked strict. However, he was kind.”

Important distinction: **however vs although**

however

typically links two independent statements:

> “He was strict. However, he was fair.”

although

subordinates one clause:

> “Although he was strict, he was fair.”

Both express contrast, but the grammar is different.

So:

> **however** ≠ **although** grammatically

even when Chinese may use:

> 然而 / 雖然 / 不過

depending on restructuring.

Important distinction: **however** vs **nevertheless**

These overlap strongly in the contrastive meaning.

however

very common neutral contrast.

nevertheless

often more explicitly means:

> despite that / even so

and can sound slightly more formal.

Compare:

> “The exam was hard. However, most students passed.”

> “The exam was hard. Nevertheless, most students passed.”

Both natural.

Nevertheless places a little more emphasis on the surprising persistence of the result.

Important distinction: **however** vs **nonetheless**

nonetheless

= nevertheless / despite that

Very similar to **nevertheless**.

however

can additionally mean:

> no matter how

Example:

> “However difficult it is...”

You cannot normally replace that with:

> **“Nonetheless difficult it is...”** ❌

So **however** has broader grammatical functions.

Important distinction: **however** vs **even so**

even so

= despite that

> “He was strict. Even so, students liked him.”

however

= broader contrast:

> “He was strict. However, he was fair.”

Even so more strongly signals:

> “despite that fact, this still happened.”

Important distinction: **however** vs **on the other hand**

however

can simply introduce a contrast.

on the other hand

often explicitly presents another side of an issue.

> “The course is difficult. However, it is useful.”

simple contrast.

> “Online learning is flexible. On the other hand, some students miss face-to-face interaction.”

two sides of an argument.

Not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **however vs whatever**

however

= no matter how / in whatever way

> “However you explain it...”

「無論你怎樣解釋.....」

whatever

= no matter what / anything that

> “Whatever you explain...”

would mean something different:

「無論你解釋甚麼.....」

So:

* however → way/manner/degree

* whatever → thing/content

Important distinction: **however vs whichever**

however

= regardless of how

> “However you answer...”

whichever

= regardless of which one

> “Whichever answer you choose...”

「無論你選哪一個答案.....」

Different grammatical variable.

Important distinction: **however much vs however many**

however much

uncountable quantity:

> however much time

「無論多少時間」

however many

plural countable quantity:

> however many questions

「無論多少條問題」

Exactly parallel to:

* much time

* many questions

Important distinction: **however + adjective vs no matter how + adjective**

These are usually equivalent:

> “However difficult the exam is...”

> “No matter how difficult the exam is...”

Both:

「無論考試有多難.....」

However is generally more compact and can sound slightly more formal.

Important punctuation note: contrastive **however**

At the beginning:

> **However,** he was fair.

In the middle:

> He was, **however,** fair.

After a semicolon:

> He was strict; **however,** he was fair.

The commas are important because **however** is functioning as a sentence adverb.

Important punctuation note: concessive **however**

No comma separates **however** from the adjective it modifies:

> **However difficult** the exam is, ...

not:

> *However, difficult the exam is...* ❌

Compare:

Contrastive:

> “The exam was difficult. **However**, I passed.”

Concessive degree:

> “**However** difficult the exam is, I will try.”

Completely different grammar.

Family-extension sweep

However has no useful morphological family to expand. Its modern learning value lies in these constructions:

- * **However**, + clause = 然而 / 不過
- * **however — nevertheless** = 儘管如此
- * **however** + adjective/adverb = 無論多.....
- * **however much** = 無論多少 / 無論多麼
- * **however many** = 無論多少個.....
- * **however** + clause = 無論怎樣 / 以任何方式
- * **however you like/want** = 隨你怎樣 / 按任何方式
- * **however did/could...?** = 到底怎麼..... ?
- * **however that may be** = 無論如何 / 不管情況怎樣

There is no need to invent derivatives here; **however** is almost entirely valuable because of its grammatical flexibility.

Master comparison

Form / function	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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However , + clause	引出與前文預期、描述或結論形成轉折 / 對比的新資訊；然而 / 不過
however — despite that	承認前文情況成立，但指出後面的結果仍不同 / 仍然發生
however + adjective/adverb	表示不論某種性質或方式的程度有多高 / 多低
however much + noun	不論某種不可數事物的數量有多少
however much + clause	不論某種感受、行為或程度有多強
however many + plural noun	不論可數人 / 事物的數量有多少
however + subject + verb	不論以甚麼方式、方法或途徑做某事
however you like/want	可按自己選擇的任何方式進行
however did/could...?	加強 how 疑問，表示驚訝或強烈好奇；到底 / 究竟怎麼.....
however that may be	不論實際情況如何，後面的判斷仍然成立

For your original sentence

> “**However**, once he started teaching, he became much more lively than people expected.”

The exact meaning is:

however = 用來引出與前文「他第一眼看起來很嚴肅」形成明顯對比的情況

So:

> **However, once he started teaching... **

= **「不過 / 然而，一旦他開始上課……」**

Natural full translation:

> **「不過，一旦他開始上課，他就比大家想像中生動得多。」**

The key contrast is:

> **first impression:** serious

> **actual classroom personality:** lively

So **however** is functioning as the bridge that tells the listener:

> **「前面是第一印象；接下來我要告訴你一個與那印象相反的情況。」**